LESSON PLAN · SPOKEN ENGLISH (GR 3–5) BEGINNER: CONFIDENT ENGLISH · LEVEL 1

Lesson 7: Tell a Story

Module 2 | 45 minutes | Beginning · middle · end | Grades 3–6 · ages 8–11

Objective: Retell a short story with a beginning, middle and end, using first, then, next and finally, and simple past tense verbs.

Success criteria

- I can tell a story with a beginning, middle and end.
- I can use first, then, next and finally.
- I can use past tense verbs like walked, went and saw.
- I can retell a story with feeling.

Key vocabulary

- **beginning**: The start of a story: who and where.
- **problem**: Something that goes wrong in the middle of a story.
- **ending**: How the problem is solved.
- **sequencing words**: Words that show order: first, then, next, finally.
- **past tense**: Verbs for things that already happened, like walked or went.
- **retell**: Tell a story again in your own words.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash (lesson video, activities)
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone); a microphone helps for speaking tasks
- Printed worksheet, paper and pencil
- Project files: l07-practice-sheet-tell-a-story.md, l07-teacher-script.md

Timed lesson plan (45 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	One-word story circle, then a one-sentence round with First, Then, Next, Finally.
5 min	**Watch + poll**	Play the video. Poll: “What was the crow’s problem?” (The water was too low.)
5 min	**Storytelling demo**	Teacher tells the story with actions, draws the four-box story map and the today/yesterday verb columns.
7 min	**Game time**	Order the story, past-tense match as a race, then Add the sequencing words.
6 min	**Build-along**	Learners draw their own four-box story map with key words.
5 min	**Pair retelling (breakout)**	Partners retell to each other, pointing to each box; listener ticks the checklist.

8 min	**Show-and-tell: story stage**	Volunteers retell on camera with voices and actions; the class gives a “story star” for the best character voice.
4 min	**Probe + exit ticket**	Yesterday at the beach (poll), then start the monsoon story (finish at home). Exit ticket in the chat.

Unplugged warm-up

One-word story circle (5 min): the class builds a story together, one word each, in the teacher’s calling order. Round two: one sentence each, starting with First, Then, Next or Finally in turn. Does the story make sense?

Teaching the idea

Learners learn story structure (beginning, middle with a problem, end), sequencing words (first, then, next, finally) and simple past tense: regular -ed verbs and common irregular verbs. They retell a well-known Indian fable, The Thirsty Crow, using a four-box story map with pictures and key words — not a memorised script. Encourage expression: character voices, slowing down at the exciting part. Lesson 5’s -ed sounds come back here: looked (t), dropped (t), wanted (id).

Analogy: A story is like a bridge: the beginning is one bank, the middle is the bridge over the river (the problem), and the end is the other bank.

Live demo: 1) Tell The Thirsty Crow dramatically with actions (flapping, peering into the pot, dropping pebbles one by one). 2) Draw the four-box story map live on the whiteboard with stick pictures. 3) Point to each box and retell it using the sequencing words — hold up one finger for each. 4) Write two columns: today / yesterday. Fill in look/looked, drop/dropped, then go/went, see/saw, fly/flew, drink/drank. 5) Tell one sentence wrongly (“He goed to the pot”) and let learners catch the mistake.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What are the three parts of a story?	Beginning, middle, end.
What happens in the middle?	There is a problem.
Name four sequencing words.	First, then, next, finally.
What is the past tense of go? Of see?	Went. Saw.
What was the crow’s clever idea?	He dropped pebbles into the pot to make the water rise.

Differentiation

Support
Use the picture story map only, and let learners say one sentence per picture. Provide the past-tense verbs on a strip.

Stretch
Retell The Lion and the Mouse with character voices, or change the ending of The Thirsty Crow and tell your new version.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
“He goed” / “He seed”	Special verbs change: went, saw. Practise them like a chant.
Mixing present and past: “He flew and sees a pot”	Keep the whole story in the past: flew… saw.
Using “then” for every sentence	Use first, then, next and finally, and starters like one day.
Telling only the ending	Tell the beginning and the problem first, so the ending makes sense.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Write the past tense of: go, see, drop.

Homework
Retell The Thirsty Crow or The Lion and the Mouse to a family member at bedtime. Finish your monsoon day story.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Order the story (perform · ordering)

Order: Once upon a time, a crow was very thirsty. → First, he flew everywhere looking for water. → Then he saw a pot with a little water at the bottom. → Next, he dropped pebbles into the pot. → Finally, the water came up and he drank happily.

2. Match each verb to its past tense (perform · matching)

go → went · see → saw · eat → ate · run → ran · find → found · say → said

3. Add the sequencing words (perform · fill blank)

Answers: First · Then · Next · Finally

4. Speak: retell The Thirsty Crow (perform · speaking)

Listen for: I told the beginning, middle and end · I used first, then, next and finally · I used past tense verbs (flew, saw, dropped, drank) · I used a different voice or feeling · I looked up at my listeners

5. New situation: yesterday at the beach (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Yesterday, I went to the beach and saw a crab.

6. New situation: a monsoon day story (probe · free response)

Look for: first, then, next, finally. **Example:** One rainy morning, Kabir looked out of the window. First, he put on his yellow raincoat. Then he jumped in every puddle on the way to the park. Next, he made a paper boat and it sailed down the street. Finally, he went home wet, muddy and very happy.

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** beginning = The start of a story: who and where. · problem = Something that goes wrong in the middle of a story. · ending = How the problem is solved. · sequencing words = Words that show order: first, then, next, finally.
2. **Order the story:** 1 Once upon a time, a crow was very thirsty. · 2 First, he flew everywhere looking for water. · 3 Then he saw a pot with a little water at the bottom. · 4 Next, he dropped pebbles into the pot. · 5 Finally, the water came up and he drank happily.
3. **Match each verb to its past tense:** go → went · see → saw · eat → ate · run → ran · find → found · say → said
4. **Add the sequencing words:** First · Then · Next · Finally
5. **New situation: yesterday at the beach:** B. Yesterday, I went to the beach and saw a crab. — Yesterday means the past: go becomes went and see becomes saw.

Kitabash original curriculum.